

BUILDING SOLVE CANADA

What is a pothole fixed a week faster worth to you?

And what changes when you can see what happened to your report?

The post people understood.

A pothole on a real street. Someone trying to get it reported.

The resident already had a reason to care. Within the week, CBC and Global called.

Make the next step obvious.

waste scattered on the ground around its base. The multi-compartment receptacle appears not to have been emptied regularly, creating an unsightly and unhygienic condition on the public sidewalk.

What we did for you

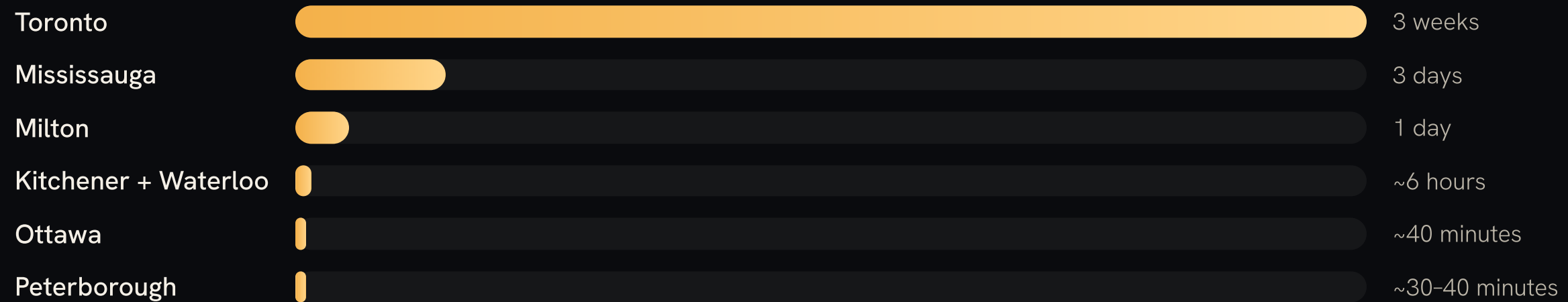
- | | |
|--|----------|
| ✓ We heard you, and saw what you saw | 11:53:35 |
| ✓ Made sure no faces or licence plates travel with your photo | 11:53:35 |
| ✓ Wrote the formal report in the city's own language, for you | 11:53:35 |
| ✓ Found your ward and put your councillor on the record, for you | 11:53:35 |
| ✓ Delivered it to Toronto 311, the same minute | 11:53:46 |
| ✓ Caught the city's reference number so you never have to chase it | Sep 10 |
| ✓ And when the city marked it fixed, we brought the answer back to you. That's the loop, closed. | Sep 11 |

Your 15-second report became all of this before 11:54 the same morning.

Show what happened. Be clear about what is still unknown.

Three weeks. Then over dinner.

My rough effort estimates: the first app, then city additions.



Initial app → additions to an existing platform. Different scope; illustrative bars.

Reuse reduced the coding effort. Local data, checking and launch decisions remained.

City wording lives in data.

```
# in a view  
current_city_copy.brand  
  
# CityCopy  
def brand  
  fetch("brand")  
end
```

Excerpts: views + app/presenters/city_copy.rb

The presenter keeps city wording out of view conditionals.

Reuse routes under a city path.

```
def mount(env, slug, rest)
  env["SCRIPT_NAME"] = "#{env['SCRIPT_NAME']}/#{slug}"
  env["PATH_INFO"]   = rest
  env[ENV_KEY]       = slug
  env
end
```

Actual mount method · lib/middleware/city_path_prefix.rb · lookup and redirects happen first

Request-aware route helpers inherit the mount prefix.

I walk. The agents build.

Talk it through. Work through the checklist. Check the behaviour.

A copied request environment broke our forms. A real form submission became the regression test.

Solve Canada

One place to report.

A shared domain, a city switcher, a session across city paths.

Less for a resident to relearn in another city.

SolveTO

SolveSAUGONING

SolveMILTON

SolveKITCHENER

SolveWATERLOO

SolveOTTAWA

SolvePTBO

NEW
BRUNSWICK

NOVA
SCOTIA

PRINCE
EDWARD
ISLAND

NEWFOUNDLAND AND
LABRADOR

QUEBEC

ONTARIO

MANITOBA

SASKATCHEWAN

ALBERTA

COLUMBIA

BRITISH COLUMBIA

NUNAVUT

YUKON

NT

AB

SK

MB

ON

QC

NS

PEI

NL

Seven names. Seven full city rows.

~1.4 TB

Total database transfer, September 1-28, 2026.
Full city loads were among the sources.

```
scope :light, -> { select(*(column_names - [ "boundary" ])) }
```

app/models/city.rb · adopted at call sites alongside a cached display directory

Make the failure visible in tests.

```
def process(method, path, **args)
  result = nil
  leaks = BoundaryGuard.capture { result = super }
  raise Minitest::Assertion, "Boundary fetched" if leaks.any?
  result
end
```

Shortened integration-request wrapper · test/support/boundary_guard.rb

First survey: 28 leaking test files. The guard covers known query shapes.

Two monitors became Ruby.

The incident record: one monitor saw failed jobs in 98 runs and alerted once.

Fixed rules now run as explicit checks. No model call.

Where does your user still have to guess?

Which place to report. Whether it arrived. What happens next.

Make those steps clearer. Then ask residents whether it helped.

The code got easy. Caring stayed hard.

Thank you.

Ahmed Nadar

Founder, Solve Canada

ahmednadar.com · solvecanada.ca · heyloon.com



Scan for the slides. I would like to hear where your users still have to guess.